

PARISH OF BANAGHER

22nd Sunday in Ordinary Time – 30th August 2026

Mass Times Mass

Times:

Monday: St. Joseph's Church, Fincairn: 9.30am
 Tuesday: St. Mary's Church, Altinure: 10.00am
 Wednesday: St. Peter's & St. Paul's Church, Foreglen: 7.00pm
 Thursday: St. Mary's Church, Altinure: 10.00am
 Friday: St. Joseph's Church, Fincairn: 9.30am

Weekend Mass Times for Sunday 6th September 2026

St. Joseph's Church, Fincairn: 7.00pm Vigil; 9.15am
 St. Mary's Church, Altinure: 10.30am

Confessions

St. Mary's Church, Altinure: Thursday 10.30am
 St. Joseph's Church, Fincairn: Friday 10.00am
 St. Joseph's Church, Fincairn: Saturday 6.30pm

Adoration of the Blessed Sacrament and Divine Mercy Chaplet

St. Mary's Church, Altinure: Thursday 10.30am – 11.30am.
 St. Joseph's Church, Fincairn: Friday 10.00am – 11.00am.

Baptism We welcome into God's family Callin Niall McLaughlin.

A Month's Mind Mass will be celebrated for Celestine O'Kane, RIP, at St. Joseph's Church, Fincairn on Saturday 5th September at 7.00pm.

Prayer for Vocations: That the men called to priesthood will be filled with courage and hope as they hear Jesus calling them to follow Him by renouncing themselves, taking up their cross every day, and finding life in Him and in the service of His people.

Blessing of the Graves 2026

The Blessing of the Graves at St. Mary's Church, Altinure will take place next **Sunday 6th September after 10.30am Mass**. Please bring a small container of water to the Ceremony of the Blessing of the Graves. This water will be blessed during the Ceremony. A member of each family will be invited to sprinkle holy water on the grave after the prayers of blessing over all the graves have been recited by the priest.

September	St Joseph's Church, Fincairn		St Mary's Church, Altinure
	7.00pm	9.15am	10.30am
Readers	Natalie McCloskey	Mary Kathleen McDermott	Noeleen McGlinchey
Eucharistic Ministers	Bernie Lynch	Geraldine McCloskey	Andrena O'Kane
Flowers	Bridget Kealey		Briege McLaughlin
Cleaning	Margaret Cartin, Angela Hasson		Audrey McElhinney, Martina Moore
Counters	Ann Hassan, Marian & Anthony O'Neill, Patricia McCloskey		Philomena Conway, Sean Conway, Karen Feeney
Collectors	Dermot Lynch Vincent McCloskey	Anthony O'Neill Patrick McGrellis	Eamon Feeney, Patrick Conway

The Padre Pio Prayer Group, Holy Family Chapel, Ballymagroarty, Derry will take place on Tuesday 1st September, starting with Rosary at 6.45pm. Celebration of Mass at 7.15pm, then the priest will bless everyone with a first class relic of St. Pio, while closing prayers are recited. Everyone welcome.

Catholic Mothers Ireland – Family Day: Catholic Mothers Ireland will hold its Annual National Mass on Sunday 6th September at Termonbacca Retreat Centre, Derry. The day will begin with Mass at 2.00pm celebrated by Bishop Donal McKeown, followed by refreshments, children's activities and a talk for parents. This promises to be a lovely day for the whole family. For more information and booking details, please email info@catholicmothers.ie. All are welcome.

Blessing of Motorcycles on Sunday 13th September at St. Aengus' Church, Burt, Co. Donegal at 1.30pm. All are very welcome. All money raised will be donated to the RNLi Station at Ned's Point, Buncrana.

Banagher Parish Monthly Cash Prize Draw ~ Tickets on Sale!

✠ Money raised will go towards the ongoing refurbishment and ✠
 ✠ maintenance of our Churches ✠

Draws for 10 Cash Prizes will take place in **October, November and December**. 30 chances to win! Tickets cost **£30** and are now on sale and available from our Church Sacristies and Parochial House and from Feeny Spar, Park Vivo, Mace Derrychrier and Sperrin View Bar. Thank you very much for your support.

Michael English Church Concert: An evening of Faith, Hope and Inspiration. The concert takes place on Friday 2nd October at 7.15pm in St. Patrick's Church, Keenaught, Desertmartin. Tickets are £30, and available to buy at Herons Gift Shop, Draperstown, Moneyneena Post Office, and at the Ballinascreen and Desertmartin Parish offices, or online with Eventbrite: <https://www.eventbrite.co.uk/e/michael-english-band-fundraising-concert-tickets-1996641829460>.

OFFERTORY COLLECTION

22nd & 23rd August 2026

St Joseph's Church, Fincairn: £1,095 St Mary's Church, Altinure: £950

Please consider online contributions and Gift Aid. Online Contributions to:

Parish of Banagher Sort Code: 950306 A/c 51052659

Thank you for your continued generosity.

Donegal Group 173 Rise and Shine Trust (formerly The Irish Handicapped Children's Pilgrimage Trust and The Irish Pilgrimage Trust) is celebrating 40 years of taking young people with special needs to Lourdes each Easter. We are celebrating with a special Mass on Saturday 26th September in the Church of the Irish Martyrs, Letterkenny, Co. Donegal at 12 noon. The Mass will be concelebrated by Bishop Niall Coll and Bishop Donal McKeown and many of the priests who travelled to Lourdes with us over the years. We invite all the guests and their families and all the helpers who travelled with us over the years to our Mass to celebrate Our Lady of Lourdes.

Feast Days this Week

Thursday 3rd September: St. Gregory the Great, also known as Pope Gregory I, was born in 540 AD into a noble Roman family. Gifted with intelligence and deep faith, he first pursued a successful career in government, becoming Prefect of Rome, yet he longed for a life of prayer and simplicity. He converted his family's villa into a monastery and lived as a monk, dedicating himself to study, service and contemplation. In 590, during a time of famine and plague, Gregory was chosen as Pope. He became one of the most influential leaders in Church history. He reformed Church administration, organized relief for the poor, promoted missionary activity and restructured the liturgy, giving rise to the singing style we now call 'Gregorian Chant'. Known for his humility, pastoral care and tireless work for both the spiritual and material welfare of his flock, Gregory earned the title 'The Great'. He died in 604 and was declared a Doctor (Teacher) of the Church.

Saturday 5th September: St. Teresa of Calcutta (1910 – 1997) Agnes Gonxha Bojaxhiu was born into an Albanian family on 26th August 1910 at Skopje in Macedonia. She left home at the age of 18 to join the Sisters of Loreto in Ireland, where she received the name Sister Mary Teresa, after St. Thérèse of Lisieux. In 1931 she was assigned to the order's Calcutta house in Indi and taught at their school there, where she eventually became headmistress. She later received a new vocation to help the poor and destitute, and in 1948, obeying this call, she left the convent and took up a new life caring for them wherever they might be, lying sick in the street or even dying in dustbins. Mother Teresa radiated light for those in need. Some of her former pupils joined her, one by one, and the new congregation of the Missionaries of Charity was established in the Diocese of Calcutta in 1950, spreading across India and eventually onto every continent. Mother Teresa of Calcutta died on 5th September 1997. She was beatified by Pope John Paul II on 19th October 2003 and canonized St. Teresa of Calcutta by Pope Francis on 4th September 2016.

JOB OPPORTUNITY

Derry Diocesan Trust: Sacristan

Hours of work: 12 hours per week. Place of work: St. John the Baptist Church, Granaghan (Swatragh) Parish. Rate of Pay: £12.88 per hour. For application packs, please email: recruitment@derrydiocese.org or telephone 028 7126 2302. Completed applications must be returned to Personnel, Bishop's House, St. Eugene's Cathedral, Francis Street, Derry, BT48 9AP or via email to recruitment@derrydiocese.org no later than **12 noon on Tuesday 15th September 2026**.

Derry Diocesan Trust is an Equal Opportunities Employer. We welcome applications from all men and women and from members of all communities.

Privacy Notice - The Diocese of Derry complies with GDPR regulations. A privacy notice is available on the Parish Website or by contacting the Parish Office. Live stream and recordings of Mass and Services in St. Joseph's Church, Fincairn, St. Mary's Church, Altinure and St. Peter's & St. Paul's Church, Foreglen are available online. Please note that the first three rows of seats are visible online in St. Joseph's Church, Fincairn and St. Peter's & St. Paul's Church, Foreglen, and the first six rows of seats in St. Mary's Church, Altinure.

COMMUNITY NEWS

Dungiven and Feeny local committee for Cancer Research UK would like to thank everyone who supported and helped in any way with our 'Dungiven Walk of Hope 2026'. The walk raised the amazing sum of £8,780.01! Thank you everyone for your continued support.

Learmount Community Development Group: To book any of our classes, trips and workshops or for further information, contact Karen or Min on 028 7778 1881 / DM / email: admin@learmountgroup.org. The Learmount Group would like to thank the amazing volunteers who gave up their time over the summer to help clean up and improve Park Village. We are truly blessed and grateful for all the help that was received.

The Parish Webcams are now available to view on the Firestick. If you search for the iTech Media App and download it to your Firestick, you can then search for the Church.

PARISH CLERGY

Fr. Dermot McGirr, P.P.

42 Glenedra Road, Feeny, BT47 4TW

Tel: 028 7778 1223 Email: banagherparish@derrydiocese.org

CONTACT US

To arrange a Baptism, Wedding or Anniversary Mass, please call Fr. Dermot or the secretaries on 028 7778 1223 or email banagherparish@derrydiocese.org.

Parish Office opening hours next week: Tuesday to Friday: 9.30am - 12.30pm.

Mass is Live on the Webcam at www.banagherparish.com
SVP Confidential Helpline: 075 9395 4973